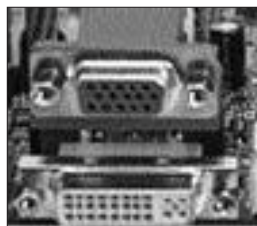


controller has been included in the CPU itself; the Northbridge is no longer burdened with this task.

1.1.5 Display port

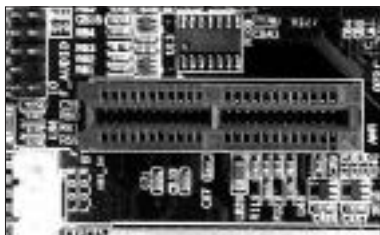
The 15-pin, mini DB 15 port, also called the VGA / Display port is used to connect an analogue monitor. With LCD monitors becoming popular, the DVI (Digital Video Interface) port is also frequently seen.



VGA on Top, DVI below

1.1.6 Expansion slots

Earlier motherboards rarely offered additional functionality besides offering a place for the CPU and RAM to be plugged in. The capability of the system had to be "expanded" with the use of external cards that carried the additional circuitry to fulfil the function. Additional circuitry usually included hard disk controllers, display adapters, sound system, etc., all of which are nowadays present "onboard" - referring to the inclusion of all this circuitry on the motherboard. Today, expansion slots on motherboards are mostly PCI, PCIE, and AGP. A couple of rarely-used slots are CNR (Communications and Networking Riser) and AMR (Audio Modem Riser). These special slots were designed to incorporate the interfaces for networking and audio devices; they did not contain the processing circuitry, and merely acted as a channel. The processing was done by the host CPU.



AMR slot

1.1.7 FireWire port

FireWire ports are not as common as USB, but do make an occasional appearance on the



AMR port